

Tianjian Qin, PhD

Computational Biologist & Data Scientist

✉ tianjian.qin@wur.nl
🌐 qtj.me | 📍 Netherlands

Prof. Dr. Lydia Afman

Nutrition, Metabolism and Genomics
Division of Human Nutrition and Health
Wageningen University & Research

27 July 2026

APPLICATION

Data Scientist (Assistant Professor) in Nutrition & Health Research

Dear Professor Afman and Members of the Selection Committee,

I am writing to apply for the Data Scientist (Assistant Professor) position in Nutrition & Health Research. I am currently a postdoctoral researcher in WUR's Infectious Disease Epidemiology group and recently completed a PhD in theoretical and computational biology at the University of Groningen. I am drawn to the opportunity to bring my computational experience to human nutrition and health and to build a research line in close collaboration with domain experts.

My work has taken me from ecology and evolution to infectious disease epidemiology. Each transition has required me to learn the field's scientific language and wider context through close collaboration with its experts. These transitions have been productive: together with collaborators, I have turned biological questions into models, software, and tools that researchers and stakeholders can use. This experience has convinced me that my strongest contribution comes from connecting computational methods with domain knowledge, rather than treating data science as a separate activity.

Human nutrition would be a new substantive domain for me, and that is part of its appeal. I am interested in how health emerges from interacting processes at several levels, and in how data can help connect them. I would bring a broad biological background and a record of making my technical expertise useful in unfamiliar settings, guided by curiosity and close collaboration. My aim would be to learn from nutrition researchers and shape meaningful questions together, so that the resulting work advances understanding and can make a societal impact.

Working at WUR has given me an appreciation for its collaborative culture and its focus on research that matters beyond academia. I would welcome the opportunity to contribute to the Division's research and teaching and to grow within a community that values collaboration across fields.

Thank you for considering my application. I would be glad to discuss my motivation and possible contribution further.

Sincerely,

Tianjian Qin